

Golden tegu

Tupinambis teguixin

A flexible diet of insects, spiders, and worms, and also vertebrates from fish to mice, eggs, fruits, and shoots allows this large lizard to colonize many habitats. The female lays 20–30 eggs in a foliage-lined burrow and may stay with them for the cold season until they hatch up to five months later.

- ↔ 40 in (100 cm)
- ⚖ 9 lb (4 kg)
- ⊗ Not known
- 🦋 Insects, birds, mammals
- 🏠 🌿 🌱 🌾
- 📍 N. to C. South America

long toes, sharp claws

tail forms half the length of body

▷ **KILLER BITE**
Strong and often aggressive, the golden tegu has a bite that can even crush bone.



Green anaconda

Eunectes murinus

The world's bulkiest and most powerful snake, the green anaconda is a nonvenomous member of the boa constrictor family. It often lies in shallow water waiting to ambush animals that come to the water's edge to drink. The snake grabs its prey with sharp, back-curved teeth, and quickly wraps it into the muscular coils. Each time the victim breathes out, the coils tighten, and death is usually from suffocation or heart failure. Almost any vertebrate prey is taken. Mating occurs in the dry season. The female may eat her much smaller male partner to nourish her pregnancy.

- ↔ 20–33 ft (6–10 m)
- ⚖ Up to 550 lb (250 kg)
- ⊗ Vulnerable
- 🦋 Reptiles, fish, mammals
- 🏠 🌿 🌱 🌾
- 📍 N. to C. South America

▷ **AMBUSH CAMOUFLAGE**
Patterned for swampy vegetation and forest undergrowth, the anaconda slides silently after quarry, or strikes from the water's edge.



Giant parrot snake

Leptophis ahaetulla

Also called the lora or giant lora, this snake is only mildly venomous. It is active during the day and rests at night. Well-camouflaged among dense undergrowth, it ambushes prey, or pursues them with great speed. It also explores crevices, caves, and vegetation for food.

If confronted, it rears up, gapes its mouth, hisses, and makes mock strikes. The female lays and leaves three to five eggs in a safe place, usually in a tree hole or mossy branch fork.

- ↔ 1.5–2 m (5–7 ft)
- ⚖ 2–3 lb (1–1.5 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🦋 Geckos, tree frogs, birds
- 🏠 🌿 🌱 🌾

Central America to South America



yellow underside

◁ BRIGHT HUES

The parrot snake gets its name because of its bright coloring: vivid green on the upper side and yellow underneath.

